spending like this, you're going to blow all your flippin' money.' Maybe she didn't swear. She's a sweet lady. But ja, so I pulled up the handbrake quite a lot with my spending.

One thing I have been financially smart with is houses – I've made money on all the houses I've bought. I bought my first place in 1996, when I finally moved out of my parents' home. It was the year I started playing for South Africa. I bought a three-bedroom apartment in High Cape below Devil's Peak in Cape Town. I think I paid about R340 000 for the flat, and I ended up living there for four years.

I eventually sold the apartment for double what I paid for it, so that worked out okay. Actually, most of the money I earned in those first few years of my national contract went into my mom's house and my parents' cars. When my parents got divorced in 2000, the bond still needed to be paid off, and my dad basically said, 'Well, it's your baby now. You've got to pay for it.'

So initially, for those first couple of years, I had to sort out my mom's house. And I bought her and my dad a car each too – my mom one of those little Toyota Rav4s, and my dad a Honda Ballade. Ja, I wasn't too fussy about the car I chose for my dad, but I was for my mom. She was very happy with the Rav – she still has it, in fact. And her house is paid off, and it's all good, you know.

As I've said, over the past few years I've made a bit of cash buying and selling houses. That's not to say I've got property everywhere. As far as my current house is concerned, playing in the IPL has been a blessing, that's for sure. Because of the IPL, I have been able to afford a great new place in Camps Bay, which I've just renovated. The property cost me a whack, but I'll be able to pay it off this year. My manager, Donné, was adamant about it: 'You buy this house, you pay it off this year.' I've learnt to listen to Donné when she uses that tone of voice.

As excessive a spender as I have been over the years, I've also been very generous when it comes to paying for people. If I'm out with friends for supper, I don't really think twice about paying for everybody, I really don't. Donné is always telling me, 'You can't be so generous all the time, Herschelle!' But I can't help it.

Look, some mates of mine have taken advantage of my generosity, but I've had a little word with them. Just one or two of them, but they know who they are. All in all, however, I've certainly cut down quite a lot on my